

THE SYSTEM

When I talk about “the system,” I’m sure I look like Charlie from *It’s Always Sunny in Philadelphia* trying to crack the case of Pepe Silvia. (Find the clip on YouTube. It’s very relatable.) It’s an unsolvable catch-22: How can I make sure I have what I need to exist and succeed within a broken system without supporting that system?

To borrow from my own tweet:

Me on Twitter: Burn the capitalist system

Me on Amazon: Check out my wish list

The first season of my podcast is devoted to conversations with people about their complicated relationships to money. By season 2, I was increasingly radicalized. The more I learned about money, the more of a socialist I became. But can I actually be a socialist? Do I have to move to the woods to do it?

Let’s back up. Capitalism is defined as a social system where goods and services are provided by individuals based on supply and demand (with prices determined by competition). This is more or less our current system. So what then is socialism?

In 2016, the membership of the Democratic Socialists of America (DSA) went from 8,000 dues-paying members to 25,000, according to a 2017 Vox article, “9 Questions about the Democratic Socialists You Were Too Afraid to Ask.” (You don’t know me! You don’t know what I’m afraid to ask!)

The same article attempted to explain what the DSA wants and believes in: socialism, or the abolition of capitalism and an economy run by the workers. How they plan to achieve this is hotly debated. The article continues, “According to DSA’s current mission statement, the government should ensure